



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Customer Relations

RESTAURANT AND FOOD SERVICES MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Demonstrate a customer service mindset.
2. Reinforce service orientation through communication.
3. Build and maintain relationships with customers.
4. Identify company's brand promise.
5. Communicate core values of product/service.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of GENERAL MANAGER at THE RUSTIC SPOON, a popular casual-dining restaurant known for farm-to-table comfort food. The OWNER (judge) has asked you to solve a service crisis created by the restaurant's recent expansion into third-party delivery apps.

THE RUSTIC SPOON has always been a neighborhood favorite, with a dining room that seats 80 people. Three months ago, to increase revenue, the Owner decided to partner with three major third-party delivery services (e.g., DoorDash, UberEats). Financially, the launch has been a success; sales are up 20%.

However, the in-house guest experience has suffered drastically. Because the kitchen prints tickets for delivery orders on the same line as dine-in orders, the kitchen is often overwhelmed.

- The Problem: On Friday and Saturday nights, dine-in customers are waiting 45 to 60 minutes for their entrees because the kitchen is backed up with delivery orders.
- The Fallout: In-house guests are complaining loudly. They see empty tables (because you have stopped seating people to give the kitchen a break), yet their food is taking an hour. Furthermore, the waitstaff is demoralized; their tips are dropping because customers are unhappy with the wait times, yet the servers have no control over the kitchen queue.

The Owner (judge) refuses to turn off the delivery tablets because the revenue is too high. However, the Owner knows that ruining the in-house experience will destroy the brand's reputation long-term.

The Owner (judge) has asked you to present a strategy to balance the high volume of delivery orders without sacrificing the experience of the dine-in guests. Your presentation must address:

- How to prioritize in-house guests when the kitchen is overwhelmed.
- Communication strategies for servers to use with frustrated customers.
- Operational changes to manage the flow of orders.

You will present your ideas to the Owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the Owner's office. The Owner will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking for your plan to fix the Friday night service failures.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How should our servers explain the long wait times to customers without blaming the kitchen or the delivery apps?
2. If the kitchen gets completely overwhelmed on a Friday night, what specific protocol should we put in place regarding the delivery tablets?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Demonstrate a customer service mindset?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Reinforce service orientation through communication?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Build and maintain relationships with customers?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Identify company's brand promise?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Communicate core values of product/service?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						